

AETHER WIRELESS · KNOWLEDGE BASE

Plan Upgrade Policy

Category B — Policy & Process Knowledge Base

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Overview

This policy establishes the rules, eligibility criteria, and procedures for Aether Wireless customers seeking to upgrade their current service plan to a higher-tier offering. It applies to all consumer plans across all sales and service channels, including retail stores, customer care, and self-service portals. The policy ensures consistent treatment of upgrade requests while protecting both customer experience and company revenue integrity.

Section 1: Eligibility Criteria

1.1 General Requirements

A customer is eligible to upgrade their plan when all of the following conditions are met:

- **Account Status:** The account must be in Active status.
- **Current Plan Tenure:** The customer must have held their current plan for a minimum of 30 days.
- **No Arrears:** The account must have no outstanding balance past the due date.
- **No Device Installment Arrears:** All device installment payments must be current; no missed or overdue installment payments.
- **KYC Verification:** Customer identity must have been verified (Know Your Customer) within the preceding 12 months.
- **No Fraud or Abuse Flag:** The account must not be flagged for fraud, billing abuse, or terms-of-service violations.

1.2 Account Status Eligibility Table

Account Status	Eligible to Upgrade
Active	Yes
Prospect (needs activation)	No – account must be activated first
Delinquent	No – arrears must be cleared
Suspended	No – suspension must be resolved

Section 2: Available Upgrade Paths

2.1 Plan Tier Hierarchy

Aether Wireless plans are organized in the following tier structure (from lowest to highest):

- 1. Essential
- 2. Standard
- 3. Premium
- 4. Unlimited
- 5. Family
- 6. Business

2.2 Permitted Upgrade Paths by Current Plan

Current Plan	Eligible Upgrade Targets
Essential	Standard, Premium, Family
Standard	Premium, Family, Unlimited
Premium	Unlimited, Family, Business
Family	Unlimited, Business
Senior	Essential, Standard, Premium (requires 60-day tenure on Senior plan)

Customers may upgrade to any plan shown in the "Eligible Upgrade Targets" column for their current plan. Lateral moves between plans of equal tier are not permitted as upgrades.

Section 3: Upgrade Process

The upgrade process consists of seven sequential steps. Customer care representatives or the self-service system must complete all steps in order.

Step 1: Verify Customer Identity

Confirm the customer's identity using the standard authentication protocol (last four digits of SSN or account PIN, plus date of birth).

Step 2: Confirm Account Status Eligibility

Review the account status table in Section 1.2. The account must be Active with no arrears or device installment delinquencies.

Step 3: Validate Current Plan Tenure

Confirm the customer has held their current plan for a minimum of 30 days. For Senior plan upgrades, confirm 60-day tenure.

Step 4: Verify KYC Status

Check that KYC verification was completed within the past 12 months. If not, request updated identity verification before proceeding.

Step 5: Analyze 60-Day Usage History

Pull the customer's usage data for the most recent 60 days. Evaluate:

- Data consumption patterns
- Voice minute usage (if applicable)
- Messaging/SMS usage
- International calling or roaming usage

This analysis determines whether the customer qualifies for recommended promotions and informs any usage-based recommendations.

Step 6: Execute the Upgrade

Apply the new plan to the account with immediate effective date. Calculate the prorated charges per Section 4.

Step 7: Confirm and Notify

Inform the customer of:

- New monthly rate
- Prorated charge or credit applied today
- Next billing cycle date
- 24-hour reversal window (see Section 7)

Send written confirmation via SMS and/or email.

Section 4: Proration

4.1 Proration Formula

When a customer upgrades mid-billing cycle, charges are prorated using the following formula:

Prorated Charge = (New Plan Price - Old Plan Price) × (Days Remaining in Cycle / Days in Current Cycle)

- **New Plan Price:** The full monthly cost of the new plan
- **Old Plan Price:** The full monthly cost of the previous plan
- **Days Remaining:** Number of days from the upgrade date through the end of the current billing cycle (inclusive of upgrade date)
- **Days in Current Cycle:** Total number of days in the billing cycle in which the upgrade occurs

4.2 Effective Date

Plan upgrades take effect immediately upon processing, not at the start of the next billing cycle. The customer receives the full benefits of the new plan for the remainder of the current cycle.

4.3 Device Installments

Device installment agreements remain unchanged when a customer upgrades their plan. The installment amount and remaining term continue as originally agreed. Plan upgrades do not modify device financing terms.

Section 5: Promotional Pricing

5.1 Stacking Rules

Promotional pricing on upgraded plans is subject to the following stacking rules:

- **Maximum of one promotional discount per account** may apply to any given billing cycle.
- Promotional discounts **do not stack** with existing plan discounts, loyalty rewards, or employee discounts.
- If a customer qualifies for multiple promotions, the system applies the **most financially advantageous** promotion automatically.
- Promotional pricing is applied **after** proration calculations.

5.2 30-Day Opt-Out

Customers who receive a promotional rate as part of their upgrade:

- Have **30 calendar days** from the upgrade date to opt out of the promotion and return to standard pricing.
- Must contact Customer Care to opt out.
- After 30 days, the promotional rate locks in for the advertised duration (if any) or becomes standard pricing at the next billing cycle.

Section 6: Usage-Based Auto Recommendations

Aether Wireless analyzes customer usage patterns to generate proactive upgrade and downgrade recommendations.

6.1 Downgrade Candidates

Customers are flagged as **downgrade candidates** when:

- Usage falls below **40%** of their plan's included allocation
- This pattern persists for **3 consecutive months**
- Recommendation is delivered via SMS at the start of each cycle

6.2 Upgrade Candidates

Customers are flagged as **upgrade candidates** when:

- Usage exceeds **80%** of their plan's included allocation
- This pattern persists for **2 consecutive months**
- Recommendation is delivered via SMS at the start of each cycle

6.3 Delivery Method

Usage-based recommendations are sent by SMS to the primary line on the account. Customers may opt out of marketing messages; however, service-related usage alerts remain enabled.

Section 7: 24-Hour Reversal Window

7.1 Policy

After a plan upgrade is processed, the customer has a **24-hour window** to reverse the upgrade and return to their previous plan without penalty.

7.2 Conditions

- The reversal request must be made within 24 hours of the upgrade transaction.
- The customer must contact Customer Care to request reversal.
- Any prorated charges paid are refunded in full.
- The customer returns to their original plan with the same billing cycle and terms.

7.3 Exclusions

The 24-hour reversal window does not apply:

- If the original plan is no longer available
- If device installment terms were modified (not applicable under standard upgrade rules)
- If the account status has changed since the upgrade

FAQs

Q: Can I upgrade my plan if I have a past-due balance on my account?

A: No. Customers must clear all arrears before being eligible for a plan upgrade. This includes any past-due balance on the primary account or device installment agreements.

Q: How is the prorated charge calculated if I upgrade 15 days into a 30-day billing cycle?

A: Using the formula $(\text{New Price} - \text{Old Price}) \times (\text{Days Remaining} / \text{Days in Cycle})$, if your old plan was \$50 and new plan is \$70 with 15 days remaining in a 30-day cycle: $(\$70 - \$50) \times (15/30) = \$20 \times 0.50 = \10 prorated charge.

Q: My account is currently suspended. Can I still upgrade my plan?

A: No. Suspended accounts are not eligible for upgrades. You must resolve the suspension and restore the account to Active status before upgrading.

Q: Can I stack my employee discount with a promotional upgrade offer?

A: No. Promotional discounts do not stack with other discounts including employee discounts, loyalty rewards, or existing plan discounts. The system will apply whichever discount provides the greater financial benefit.

Q: What happens to my device installments when I upgrade my plan?

A: Device installment agreements remain unchanged. Your monthly installment amount and remaining term continue as originally agreed. Plan upgrades do not modify device financing terms.

Q: How do I reverse an upgrade if I change my mind?

A: Contact Customer Care within 24 hours of your upgrade. A representative will reverse the upgrade, restore your previous plan, and refund any prorated charges paid. Note that this is not available if your original plan is no longer available.

For assistance with plan upgrades, contact Customer Care at 1-800-AETHER or visit your nearest Aether Wireless retail location.